What if the same structural laws that govern how a person turns intention into action also govern how an AI turns a prompt into a response?

The Cognitive Architecture System is a formal framework that maps the structure of thought across any substrate, human or artificial. Ten Noetics describe what a mind is doing. Four Processing Domains describe at what level. Seven Core Drives describe why.

Together they give you what a vocabulary of "bias" and "heuristic" never did: a notation precise enough to write a mind down, compare two of them, and say exactly where one is failing.

The book moves from the ten primitives to the forty cognitive states, through the prerequisite chains that make capability possible, and into the inversions that make sophisticated minds fail in predictable ways. Then it turns the instrument on artificial minds — assessment, adversarial resilience, and what it takes to build an AI that is architecturally sound rather than merely well-behaved.

Twenty-eight chapters. Ten appendices. A complete formal system, taught from nothing.

Little Henderson is the creator of the Cognitive Architecture System and the Noetic Compass assessment framework, and the author of the Noetic Compass Press series.

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Thinking in Cognitive Architecture

A Universal Framework for Humans, AI, and Biological Minds



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